

March 13, 2026

Dr. Sean Murphy
Weill Cornell Medicine

Dear Dr. Murphy,

I am writing to apply for the Research Associate position in your laboratory at Weill Cornell Medicine. I am currently a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University and expect to complete my degree in May 2026. My research focuses on quantitative analysis using large micro and panel datasets, and I am particularly interested in applying econometric methods to questions in public health and health services research.

My dissertation research combines economic modeling with empirical analysis of microdata to study household financial behavior and inequality. In addition, one of my ongoing projects examines the relationship between trust and financial outcomes using the Health and Retirement Study (HRS). Working with HRS has required extensive experience with large survey datasets, data cleaning and construction, and implementing statistical analyses in programming environments such as Stata and Python. These experiences have prepared me well to work with complex health and administrative datasets similar to those used in health economics and health services research.

Beyond my dissertation work, I have extensive experience producing research outputs collaboratively. I routinely develop statistical code, generate empirical results and visualizations, and contribute to academic writing including manuscripts and research reports. I am comfortable managing multiple research tasks simultaneously and working within interdisciplinary teams. My background in applied econometrics, combined with experience working with micro-level panel data, would allow me to contribute immediately to ongoing economic evaluations and empirical analyses in your group.

I am particularly excited about the opportunity to work in a multidisciplinary environment focused on improving outcomes for individuals with substance use disorders, HIV, and related conditions. The opportunity to contribute to rigorous economic evaluations that inform clinical and policy decision-making is especially compelling to me, and I would welcome the chance to contribute to ongoing projects and future grant proposals within your research program.

Thank you for your consideration. I would be delighted to discuss how my quantitative research experience and interest in applied health economics could contribute to the work of your laboratory.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards